

WOOP

Wish, outcome, obstacle, plan. Picture the best result, then the thing inside you that gets in the way, then what you will do when it does.

FOR A HABIT · GABRIELE OETTINGEN, 2014 · TAKES FIVE MINUTES

HOW TO RUN IT

1. **Wish.** Write one thing you want to do, in the next day, week or month. Challenging, but possible.
2. **Outcome.** The best thing about achieving it. Write it, then close your eyes and picture it properly for a minute. Don't skip the picturing; the contrast is the method.
3. **Obstacle.** The main thing inside you that stops you. Not the weather, not other people: a habit, a feeling, an excuse you reach for. Picture that too.
4. **Plan.** Write "If [the obstacle shows up], then I will [one specific action]." Say it out loud once.
5. Do it in that order every time. Wish, outcome, obstacle, plan. Swapping the obstacle and the outcome, or leaving the obstacle out, is what turns it back into daydreaming.
6. Repeat for the next wish. One WOOP per wish, and a new one each day if you like.

Where it falls down. Leaving out the obstacle, because it feels negative, which is exactly the version her research found does nothing.

WITH A PEN

Wish

One thing, this week or this month. Hard but possible

Outcome

The best thing about it. Picture it for a full minute

Obstacle

The thing inside you that stops you. A habit, a feeling, an excuse

Plan

If [the obstacle shows up], then I will [one specific action]